contacts have added fear and suspicion of the motives of other powers.' He saw his role as 'inducing a more balanced and cooperative mentality in Peking' based on his understanding of the psychological factors affecting Chinese policy.[57]

Andrew Kennedy describes Nehru's foreign policy as an attempt to reconcile realism and idealism. According to Kennedy, Nehru 'was idealistic in the sense that he sought to transform international norms and institutions on the basis of moral principles. In doing so, however, Nehru also sought to secure advantages for India and in that sense his idealism often had a realist edge.' Kennedy argues that even if we focus on Nehru's 'most important "idealistic" preoccupations in foreign policy: the UN, non-alignment and nuclear disarmament' we see that he 'was both sincerely committed to what he saw as a moral cause and convinced that advancing it would serve India well'. Nehru did not support the UN simply out of an idealist desire to make the world a better place. He saw the prospect of a stronger UN advancing important Indian interests. [58] In Kennedy's view, Nehru saw the United Nations 'as an opportunity to reshape the international system in ways that were both morally desirable and consistent with India's interests in particular'.[59] Nehru saw the UN as a guarantor of India's sovereignty while promoting international peace and to him 'it offered a foundation on which India could establish itself and commence its rise to greatness'.

Nehru's realism also manifested in his stance on nuclear weapons. Nehru championed nuclear disarmament as a key part of his campaign for global peace. In Kennedy's words, 'While making the case against nuclear weaponry India's Prime Minister often sounded like an idealist who was both anxious about the threat of nuclear war and optimistic about the possibility of international cooperation.' However, Nehru's disarmament diplomacy reflected not only 'some degree of idealism' but also 'his perception of narrower Indian interests. Nehru was not willing to sign on to